

THE HAPPY PRINCE

Q.1 Why do the courtiers call the prince the Happy Prince? Is he really happy? What does he see around?

Ans. The prince led a happy and luxurious life. He did not know what tears were and sorrow was not allowed to enter his palace. For this reason, the courtiers called him 'The Happy Prince.' When the prince died and his statue was set up in the city, he was still known by the same name. But after the death, the prince got so gloomy because he could see the people of his town living in misery. He could feel the suffering of his people.

Q.2 Why does the Happy Prince send a ruby for the seamstress? What does the swallow do in the seamstress' home?

Ans. The Happy Prince sent a ruby for the seamstress because she was poor and couldn't arrange oranges for her ailing son. The swallow put the ruby on the table and fanned the boy's forehead with its wings. The mother didn't have anything to give the child except the river water which pained the Prince and hence the Prince asked the Swallow to carry the ruby to the seamstress

Q3 For whom does the Prince send the sapphires and why?

Ans. The prince sends one sapphire for a playwright and the other for a poor match girl. The playwright is very poor. He has no fire wood to keep himself warm. The match girl starts weeping after she accidentally throws her matches into a drain. The Happy Prince helps them by sending his sapphires to them.

Q.4. What does the swallow see when it flies over the city?

Ans. When the swallow flies over the city, it sees the rich enjoying in their houses while the beggars are begging at their gates. The swallow even sees two little boys lying in each other's arms to keep themselves warm.

Q.5 Why did the swallow not leave the prince and go to Egypt?

Ans. The prince sacrificed everything for the poor and down trodden. He sacrificed even the two sapphires of his eyes thereby making it hard for anybody to prove more generous than himself. These unusual traits of the Happy Prince had a deep impact on the swallow's heart. The swallow got emotionally attached to the Happy Prince and abandoned the idea of going away to Egypt.

Q.6. Why is the statue of the Prince described as looking like a beggar and being no longer useful?

Ans. The statue of the prince had lost all that had made it great. It had lost all its gold, sapphires and the ruby. It looked worn out like a beggar.

Q.7 What proclamation does the mayor make about the death of the birds?

Ans. The proclamation made by the Mayor was that no birds should be allowed to die at the feet of the statue.

Q.8 What impression do you gather of his personality from this?

Ans. From the Mayor's remarks we gather that he was a censorious person. Instead of thinking about the disappearance of the Prince's assets, he makes a proclamation without any rationale.

Q.9 What were the two precious things the angel brought to God? In what way were they precious?

Ans. The two precious things were the leaden heart of the prince and the dead swallow. They were precious because both had compassion and love in their hearts. The prince sacrificed everything for the poor. The swallow sacrificed its life for the prince. The prince could not bear the swallow's death. When the swallow fell down dead, the prince's heart split into two halves.

The two loved each other very much. Their love for each other was so deep and unfathomable that they could not be apart even after death.

Q.10 What happened to the prince's laden heart? What feelings does the end of the story arouse in you?

Ans. The prince's heart broke into two when the bird fell dead at its feet. When the leaden heart was put into furnace, it did not melt. So it was thrown away. Therefore, the dead bird and the laden heart met even after death. The end of the story arouses in us deep sympathy for the two.